Nimbus Labs

Employee Handbook

Version 3.2 · January 2026 · For internal use only

Policies · HR · Finance

Nimbus Labs is a fictional company created for a classroom demo. All names, numbers and policies are made up.

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1. Welcome to Nimbus Labs

Nimbus Labs Private Limited is a software company founded in 2021 and headquartered in Bengaluru, India. We build Nimbus Ledger, a cloud accounting product used by more than 4,000 small businesses, and Nimbus Pay, a payments layer that plugs into it. As of 1 January 2026 we are 182 people across two offices and remote locations.

This handbook explains how we work: the policies everyone follows, what the company offers you as an employee, and how money moves inside the company. It applies to every full-time employee of Nimbus Labs in India. Interns and contractors follow their own agreements, and where those agreements are silent, this handbook applies.

Our mission and values

Our mission is to make accounting invisible for small businesses. We hold ourselves to four values:

- **Customers first.** Every decision starts with what is best for the business owner using our product.
- **Write it down.** Decisions, plans and policies are written, so that people who were not in the room can follow them.
- **Own the outcome.** If you start something, you see it through or hand it over clearly.
- **Be kind and direct.** Disagree openly, give feedback early, and assume good intent.

Our offices

Office	Address	Working days
Bengaluru (HQ)	4th Floor, Prestige Tech Park, Outer Ring Road, Bengaluru 560103	Mon to Fri
Pune	2nd Floor, Panchshil Business Park, Baner, Pune 411045	Mon to Fri

Employees who live more than 60 km from both offices may be approved as fully remote by their department head and the HR team.

How to use this handbook

The handbook has three parts. Part A covers company policies (conduct, working hours, security, harassment and confidentiality). Part B covers HR topics (hiring, leave, holidays, reviews, learning, benefits, referrals and exit). Part C covers finance topics (payroll, expenses, travel, procurement and company assets). The Addendum at the end lists changes made after this version was published; where the Addendum and an earlier section disagree, the Addendum wins.

Questions about any policy go to the People team at people@nimbuslabs.example or on the #ask-people Slack channel. Finance questions go to finance@nimbuslabs.example or #ask-finance.

Part A: Company Policies

2. Code of Conduct

This code applies to every employee, at the office, while working remotely, at client sites and at company events. It also applies online: on Slack, email, social media and in our product's customer community.

Expected behaviour

- Treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect, whatever their role, background or seniority.
- Follow the law in every country we operate in, including tax, data protection and labour laws.
- Be honest in all records you create: timesheets, expense claims, sales figures, test results and reports.
- Raise concerns early. Silence about a problem you have seen is itself a breach of this code.
- Use company resources (money, laptops, accounts, time) for company work.

Behaviour we do not accept

- Harassment, bullying, discrimination or threats of any kind.
- Working under the influence of alcohol or drugs. Alcohol at approved company events is allowed in moderation.
- Sharing confidential information without permission, including customer data, salaries and unreleased plans.
- Accepting bribes, or offering anything of value to win business improperly.
- Retaliating against anyone who reported a concern in good faith.

Social media

You may say you work at Nimbus Labs on your personal profiles. Do not speak on behalf of the company unless the Marketing team has asked you to. Never post screenshots of internal tools, customer names or dashboards. If a journalist contacts you, forward them to press@nimbuslabs.example and do not comment.

Consequences

Breaches of this code are handled under the disciplinary process in the Separation and Exit chapter. Depending on how serious it is, the outcome can be a verbal warning, a written warning, a final written warning, or termination. Fraud, violence, sexual harassment and theft of customer data can lead to immediate termination without notice.

Reporting a concern

Report concerns to your manager, to the People team, or anonymously through the Ethics Line at ethics.nimbuslabs.example. Reports to the Ethics Line go to the Chief People Officer and an independent board member. Every report gets a written acknowledgement within 3 working days.

3. Working Hours, Attendance and Hybrid Work

Core hours

The standard working week is 40 hours, Monday to Friday. Core collaboration hours are 11:00 to 16:00 IST: be reachable during this window unless you are on leave or have blocked focus time on your calendar. Outside core hours, plan your day with your team.

Customer Support and Site Reliability Engineering run on rosters that cover weekends. People on these rosters get a compensatory off for every weekend day worked, to be used within 60 days.

Hybrid work

Nimbus Labs is a hybrid company. Employees attached to an office work from the office on **Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday** and may work from home on Monday and Friday. Teams may choose to swap one office day with written approval from their department head.

Employees who work from home receive a **work-from-home stipend of Rs. 2,000 per month**, paid with salary, to cover internet and electricity. Fully remote employees receive the same stipend. (See the Addendum for the revised amount.)

Attendance

Office attendance is recorded by the access card at the main door. There is no punching in or out for working hours. If you will miss an office day, tell your manager on Slack before 10:00 that day.

Overtime

We do not expect regular late nights. If your team regularly works beyond 45 hours a week, your manager must raise it with the department head. Employees covered by the Shops and Establishments Act overtime rules are paid overtime at twice the hourly rate, as the law requires.

Working from another city

You may work from another city in India for up to 20 working days a year, with your manager's approval, as long as you keep core hours. Working from outside India

needs approval from both HR and Finance, because of tax and data rules, and is limited to 15 working days a year.

4. Information Security and Acceptable Use

We hold the financial records of thousands of businesses. A single leak could end the company. Every employee is responsible for security.

Accounts and passwords

- Use the company password manager (1Password) for every work account.
- Turn on multi-factor authentication on every account that supports it. Hardware keys are issued to engineers with production access.
- Never share your password or MFA codes, not even with IT. IT will never ask for them.
- Lock your screen whenever you step away (Ctrl+Cmd+Q on a Mac).

Data classification

Class	Examples	Rules
Public	Website, blog posts, published docs	Can be shared freely
Internal	Roadmaps, this handbook, Slack	Employees only
Confidential	Salaries, contracts, board decks	Named people only, never on personal devices
Restricted	Customer financial data, API keys	Production systems only, access logged and reviewed

Using AI tools

You may use the AI assistants approved by IT (listed on the IT wiki) for work. Never paste Confidential or Restricted data, including customer records, source code from private repositories or API keys, into any AI tool that is not on the approved list.

Devices

Company data may only be stored on company laptops, which are encrypted and managed by IT. You may read email and Slack on a personal phone only after installing the device management profile. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to it-security@nimbuslabs.example within 1 hour.

Security incidents

If you click a suspicious link, see data where it should not be, or think an account was taken over, report it in #security-incident immediately. Reporting quickly is never punished. Hiding an incident is a disciplinary matter.

Security training

All employees complete security training within 14 days of joining and again every year in January. Phishing tests run every quarter.

5. Customer Data and Privacy

Our customers trust us with their invoices, bank statements, payroll and tax filings. Handling that data well is part of every job here, not only the security team's. This chapter follows India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act) and our customer contracts.

Principles

- **Purpose:** use customer data only to provide and improve the service the customer signed up for.
- **Minimum access:** ask for access only to the data you need, for as long as you need it.
- **No copies:** never download customer data to your laptop, a spreadsheet or a personal drive.
- **Anonymise for testing:** test and staging environments use generated or masked data only.

Access to production data

Access to production databases is granted through a ticket on Pulse, approved by the data owner, and expires after **8 hours**. Every query on production is logged. The Security team reviews access logs every week, and any access without a linked ticket is investigated.

Customer requests

Customers and their employees may ask to see, correct or delete their personal data. Forward any such request to privacy@nimbuslabs.example within 1 working day. The Privacy team responds within 30 days.

Data retention

Data	Kept for	Why
Accounting records of active customers	While the account is active	To run the service
Accounting records after a customer leaves	8 years	Indian tax and company law
Support chats and emails	3 years	Quality and disputes

Application logs	180 days	Security investigations
Job applicant data (not hired)	12 months	Future openings, with consent

Personal data breaches

A suspected breach of personal data is a security incident: report it in #security-incident straight away. The Privacy team decides, with Legal, whether the Data Protection Board and the affected customers must be told, and does so without delay.

Sharing data with vendors

Customer data may be shared with a vendor only if the vendor has passed the IT security review and signed a data processing agreement. The current list of approved sub-processors is published on our website.

6. Diversity, Inclusion and Accessibility

We hire, pay and promote people on the basis of their work. We do not discriminate on the basis of gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, caste, religion, region, language, age, disability, marital status or pregnancy.

Inclusive hiring

Job descriptions are reviewed for biased language before they are posted. Every hiring panel includes at least one woman. Interview questions are the same for every candidate for a role, and panels score candidates before discussing them.

Pay equity

Every year after the October review, the People team checks pay for people at the same level and role. Gaps that cannot be explained by performance or experience are corrected in the November pay revision.

Accessibility

Both offices are wheelchair accessible. Employees with a disability can ask for reasonable adjustments, such as screen readers, ergonomic equipment, flexible hours or extra work-from-home days. Requests go to your HR Business Partner and are answered within 10 working days.

Employee groups

Employees run groups such as Women at Nimbus, Nimbus Pride and Parents at Nimbus. Each group gets a budget of Rs. 60,000 a year for events, and one hour a month of working time for members to meet.

Language at work

English is our working language for documents, meetings and Slack channels, so that everyone can follow. Use any language you like in personal conversations.

7. Anti-Harassment (POSH) and Grievances

Nimbus Labs follows the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (the POSH Act). Our policy protects employees of all genders, as well as interns, contractors and visitors.

What counts as sexual harassment

Any unwelcome sexual behaviour, directly or by implication: physical contact or advances, a demand or request for sexual favours, sexually coloured remarks, showing pornography, or any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature. It applies at the office, at events, on business travel, and on chat and video calls.

Internal Committee

Our Internal Committee (IC) has four members. It is chaired by a senior woman employee and includes an external member from an NGO. The current members are listed on the People wiki. You can reach the committee at ic@nimbuslabs.example.

How a complaint works

- File a written complaint with the IC within 3 months of the incident (the IC can extend this by another 3 months for good reasons).
- The IC may try conciliation if the person complaining asks for it. No money settlement can be part of conciliation.
- Otherwise the IC runs an inquiry and finishes it within 90 days.
- The IC sends its report and recommendations to management within 10 days of finishing the inquiry, and management acts on them within 60 days.
- Everything about the complaint is confidential.

Other grievances

For any other workplace problem (with a manager, a team, a policy or pay), talk to your manager first. If that does not resolve it within 10 working days, raise it with your HR Business Partner, and then with the Chief People Officer. You can skip any step if the problem involves that person.

8. Conflict of Interest, Gifts and Confidentiality

Conflict of interest

A conflict of interest is any situation where your personal interest could affect a decision you make for the company. Examples: hiring a relative, buying from a vendor owned by a friend, or holding shares in a competitor. Declare any conflict in the Declarations form on Pulse within 7 days of it arising. A declared conflict is usually fine; a hidden one is not.

Side projects

You may work on side projects and open source outside working hours, on your own devices, as long as they do not compete with Nimbus Labs and do not use company data or code. Paid work for another company needs written approval from your department head.

Gifts and hospitality

You may accept a gift from a vendor or customer worth up to Rs. 2,500. Anything more must be declared on Pulse and is usually donated or shared with the team. Never accept cash, vouchers or gifts during an open tender or contract negotiation.

Confidentiality

Your employment agreement includes a confidentiality clause that continues after you leave. Confidential information includes customer data, source code, pricing, salaries, investor information and unreleased features. When in doubt, treat it as confidential.

Intellectual property

Code, designs, documents and inventions you create in the course of your work belong to Nimbus Labs. Open source contributions made as part of your job are allowed under the Open Source Policy on the engineering wiki.

Part B: HR

9. Hiring, Onboarding and Probation

Hiring

Every open role has a written job description and a hiring panel of at least three people, including one person from outside the team. Candidates do a short paid take-home task (paid Rs. 5,000) or a live pairing session, never both. Offers are approved by the department head and the People team.

Background checks

Offers depend on a background check covering identity, education and the last two employers. Checks are done by an external agency and usually take 7 to 10 working days.

Your first week

- Day 1: laptop handover, accounts set up, meet your buddy and your manager.
- Day 2: product walk-through with the Product team, security training starts.
- Days 3 to 5: team rituals, first small task, 30-60-90 day plan agreed with your manager.

Probation

Every new employee has a **probation period of 6 months**. Your manager reviews you at 3 months and again before the 6-month mark. Probation can be extended once by up to 3 months, with written reasons. During probation the notice period is **15 days** on either side.

Leave during probation: you earn leave from your first day but can use earned leave only after completing 3 months. Sick leave can be used from day one.

Buddy programme

Each new employee is paired with a buddy from another team for the first 90 days. Buddies get Rs. 3,000 for team lunches during that time.

10. Leave Policy

This chapter covers every type of leave at Nimbus Labs. The leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**. All leave is applied for and approved on **Pulse**, our HR portal. Leave for employees who join mid-year is given pro rata.

Leave entitlement at a glance

Leave type	Days per year	Carry forward	Notes
Earned leave (EL)	24 (2 per month)	Up to 15 days	Encashable on exit
Sick leave (SL)	8	No	Doctor's note for more than 2 days in a row
Casual leave (CL)	6	No	Max 2 days at a time
Maternity leave	26 weeks	-	For the first two children
Paternity leave	10 working days	-	Within 3 months of the birth
Adoption leave	12 weeks	-	Child under 3 months, for the adopting mother
Bereavement leave	5 working days	-	Immediate family
Marriage leave	3 working days	-	Once during employment

Earned leave

You earn 2 days of earned leave for every month worked, 24 days a year. Apply for earned leave of more than 2 days at least **7 days in advance** so your team can plan. You may carry forward up to 15 unused days into the next year; anything above 15 days lapses on 31 December. Earned leave cannot be taken in advance of earning it, except with the department head's approval for up to 5 days.

Sick leave

You get 8 days of sick leave a year. Tell your manager on the first morning you are unwell. For more than 2 days in a row, upload a doctor's note on Pulse when you are back. Unused sick leave lapses at the end of the year. If you run out of sick leave, further sick days come from earned leave.

Casual leave

Casual leave is for short personal matters: up to 6 days a year, at most 2 days at a time. It cannot be combined with earned leave to make a longer break.

Maternity and paternity

Following the Maternity Benefit Act, women employees get 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children and 12 weeks from the third child. Up to 8 weeks can be taken before the expected delivery date. After maternity leave, you may work from home for up to 3 months, by agreement with your manager. Fathers and secondary parents get 10 working days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 3 months of the birth or adoption.

Leave without pay

When all paid leave is used, you may ask for leave without pay for up to 30 days a year. It needs approval from your manager and the People team, and salary is cut for each day taken.

Public holidays and optional holidays

We observe 10 fixed public holidays and 2 optional holidays a year. The 2026 calendar is on the next page.

Leave encashment

Earned leave is not encashed during employment. On exit, up to 30 days of unused earned leave are paid out at your basic salary per day (monthly basic divided by 30). Sick and casual leave are never encashed.

11. Holiday Calendar 2026

Fixed holidays apply to everyone. In addition, choose any 2 optional holidays from the second table on Pulse by 31 January 2026.

Fixed holidays

#	Date	Day	Holiday
1	26 January 2026	Monday	Republic Day
2	4 March 2026	Wednesday	Holi
3	20 March 2026	Friday	Eid al-Fitr
4	1 May 2026	Friday	Maharashtra Day / May Day
5	15 August 2026	Saturday	Independence Day
6	14 September 2026	Monday	Ganesh Chaturthi
7	2 October 2026	Friday	Gandhi Jayanti
8	20 October 2026	Tuesday	Dussehra
9	8 November 2026	Sunday	Diwali (observed Mon 9 November)
10	25 December 2026	Friday	Christmas

Optional holidays (pick any 2)

Date	Holiday
14 January 2026	Makar Sankranti / Pongal
3 April 2026	Good Friday
27 May 2026	Bakrid
28 August 2026	Raksha Bandhan
24 November 2026	Guru Nanak Jayanti

Holiday list approved by the Chief People Officer on 12 December 2025.

12. Performance Reviews and Promotions

Review cycles

Performance reviews happen twice a year: the **mid-year review in April** and the **annual review in October**. Pay revisions and promotions take effect from **1 November**, after the annual review.

How a review works

- You write a self-review on Pulse covering goals, impact and growth areas.
- Two to four peers you choose, agreed with your manager, give written feedback.
- Your manager writes the review and proposes a rating.
- Ratings are calibrated across the department so that the same rating means the same thing in every team.
- Your manager shares the final review with you in a one-to-one meeting.

Rating scale

Rating	Meaning	Typical pay revision
5 - Exceptional	Far above expectations; impact beyond the team	12% to 18%
4 - Strong	Consistently above expectations	8% to 12%
3 - Solid	Meets expectations for the level	5% to 8%
2 - Developing	Meets some expectations; clear gaps	0% to 3%
1 - Below	Does not meet expectations	0%, performance plan

Promotions

Promotions follow the career ladder on the People wiki. A promotion needs a written case from your manager, showing that you have worked at the next level for at least 6 months, and approval from the promotion committee. Promotions come with a pay increase of at least 10%.

Performance improvement plan

An employee rated 1 is put on a performance improvement plan (PIP) of 60 days with clear, written goals and weekly check-ins. If the goals are met, the PIP closes. If not,

the company may end employment with the standard notice period.

13. Learning and Development

We want everyone to grow faster here than they would anywhere else.

Learning budget

Every employee has a **learning budget of Rs. 40,000 per financial year** (April to March). It can be used for courses, certifications, books, and conference tickets. Unused budget does not carry forward. Claim it as an expense under the category 'Learning' with the receipt.

Conferences

If you speak at a conference, the company pays for travel and stay under the Travel Policy, outside your learning budget. Attending (not speaking) at a conference uses your learning budget for the ticket; travel needs your manager's approval.

Learning time

You may spend up to 4 hours a month of working time on learning. Block it on your calendar as 'Learning'.

Certification bonds

For any single course or certification costing more than Rs. 1,00,000 (approved outside the normal budget), you sign a learning agreement: if you leave within 12 months of finishing it, you repay the cost pro rata.

Internal mobility

After 12 months in your role you may apply for an open internal role. Tell your manager before you apply. Internal candidates are interviewed for every open role they apply to.

14. Rewards and Recognition

Good work deserves to be noticed, not only at review time.

Kudos

Anyone can post a kudos in the #kudos Slack channel. Every month, the leadership team picks three kudos posts and the people named receive a gift voucher of Rs. 5,000 each.

Spot awards

Managers can give a spot award of up to **Rs. 10,000** for exceptional work, such as fixing a major incident at night or closing an important customer. Each manager can give at most 4 spot awards a quarter. Spot awards are paid with the next salary and are taxable.

Annual awards

Award	Who chooses	Prize
Customer Hero	Customer Support votes	Rs. 50,000 + trophy
Builder of the Year	Engineering and Product leads	Rs. 50,000 + trophy
Culture Champion	All employees vote	Rs. 50,000 + trophy
Rookie of the Year	Department heads	Rs. 30,000 + trophy

Annual awards are announced at the company offsite in December.

Long service

On your 3rd, 5th and 10th work anniversaries you receive a long-service award of Rs. 15,000, Rs. 30,000 and Rs. 75,000 respectively. On your 5th anniversary you may also take a paid sabbatical of 4 weeks within the following year.

15. Employee Stock Options (ESOP)

Most employees at Nimbus Labs are offered stock options, so that everyone shares in the company's success. The details of your grant are in your grant letter; this chapter explains how the plan works in general.

Who gets options

Full-time employees at level 2 and above receive an options grant with their offer. Further grants (refreshers) may be given after the annual review to people rated 4 or 5, and on promotion.

Vesting

Options vest over **4 years with a 1-year cliff**. This means 25% of your options vest on the first anniversary of your grant date, and the rest vest in equal parts every quarter over the next 3 years. If you leave before the first anniversary, no options vest.

Time since grant	Vested (cumulative)
Less than 12 months	0%
12 months	25%
24 months	50%
36 months	75%
48 months	100%

Exercising options

To own shares, you exercise your vested options by paying the exercise price written in your grant letter. While you work here, you can exercise at any time after vesting. If you leave, you have **5 years** from your last working day to exercise vested options. Unvested options lapse on your last working day.

Tax

Exercising options creates a taxable benefit: the difference between the fair market value on the exercise date and the exercise price is taxed as salary. Selling the shares later may create capital gains tax. Talk to a tax adviser before you exercise.

Buybacks

The company has run two buybacks, in 2024 and 2025, letting employees sell up to 20% of their vested shares. Future buybacks are not guaranteed.

16. Benefits and Insurance

Health insurance

Every employee is covered by a group health insurance policy from the date of joining. The policy is a **family floater of Rs. 5,00,000** per year covering the employee, spouse or partner, and up to two children. The company pays the full premium.

You may add your parents or parents-in-law with a parental cover of Rs. 3,00,000. The premium for parents is deducted from your salary.

Other insurance

Benefit	Cover	Who pays
Group health (family floater)	Rs. 5,00,000	Company
Parental health cover	Rs. 3,00,000	Employee (salary deduction)
Group term life	3 times annual fixed pay	Company
Group personal accident	Rs. 20,00,000	Company
Annual health check-up	Once a year, for employees over 30	Company

Wellbeing

All employees and their families can use free, confidential counselling sessions through our Employee Assistance Programme, up to 6 sessions a year. We also pay for a gym or fitness app membership up to Rs. 1,500 per month, claimed as an expense.

Meals and snacks

Lunch is provided at both offices on office days. Snacks and coffee are available all day.

Retirement benefits

The company contributes 12% of basic salary to the Employees' Provident Fund. Gratuity is paid under the Payment of Gratuity Act after 5 years of continuous service.

17. Company Events and Offsites

Company offsite

Once a year, in December, the whole company meets for a 3-day offsite. The company pays for travel, stay and meals. Attendance is expected; if you cannot come, tell your manager at least 30 days before.

Team outings

Each team has an outing budget of **Rs. 2,500 per person per quarter**, managed by the team's manager. Budgets do not carry over to the next quarter. Claim team outings under the 'Team events' category on Pulse with the itemised bill.

All-hands meetings

The CEO hosts an all-hands meeting on the first Friday of every month at 16:00 IST, in the Bengaluru office and on video. Questions can be asked anonymously in advance on the Ask Anything board.

Safety at events

- The Code of Conduct and the POSH policy apply at every company event, including after-parties.
- When alcohol is served, the company also arranges cabs home for everyone, paid by the company.
- If you feel unsafe at an event, contact the event lead or any member of the Internal Committee.

Family day

Every year in August, each office holds a family day where employees can bring their families to see where they work.

18. Employee Referral Programme

The best people often come from people who already work here. Refer anyone you think would be great, through the Referrals page on Pulse.

Referral bonus

Role level	Bonus
Individual contributor (levels 1 to 3)	Rs. 50,000
Senior and staff (levels 4 to 5)	Rs. 75,000
Managers and above	Rs. 1,00,000

The bonus is paid with salary after the person you referred completes **90 days** at Nimbus Labs, and you are still employed on that date.

Rules

- No bonus for referring someone who applied directly in the last 6 months.
- Hiring managers and members of the hiring panel for the role do not get a bonus for it.
- Interns and rehires of former employees are not eligible.
- If two employees refer the same person, the first referral on Pulse counts.

19. Separation and Exit

Notice period

After probation, the notice period is **60 days** for everyone, on either side. During probation it is 15 days. The company may accept a shorter notice period, or pay salary in place of notice. Earned leave cannot be used to shorten the notice period.

Resigning

Submit your resignation on Pulse. Your manager and HR Business Partner will meet you within 3 working days. Your last working day is 60 days after the resignation date unless agreed otherwise.

Exit checklist

- Hand over your work, documented on the team wiki.
- Return your laptop and accessories to IT **by your last working day**. Remote employees get a courier pickup.
- Clear any pending expense claims and return company cards.
- Complete the exit interview with the People team.

Full and final settlement

The full and final settlement, including leave encashment and any pending reimbursements, is paid within **45 days** of your last working day. Your relieving letter and experience letter are emailed on the day of the settlement.

Disciplinary process

For breaches of policy, the company follows a fair process: a written notice of the issue, a chance to respond within 5 working days, a decision by a panel that does not include your manager, and a right to appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 days of the decision.

20. On-call and Weekend Support

Our customers close their books at all hours, so some teams must be available outside normal working hours.

Who is on call

Engineers in the Platform, Payments and Ledger teams, and Site Reliability Engineers, join the on-call rotation after completing 3 months and the on-call training. A rotation lasts one week, from Monday 10:00 IST to the next Monday 10:00 IST.

On-call allowance

Situation	Allowance
Each week on call (primary)	Rs. 6,000
Each week on call (secondary)	Rs. 3,000
Each incident handled between 22:00 and 07:00	Rs. 1,500 extra
Public holiday on call	Rs. 2,000 extra per day, plus a compensatory off

Response times

Severity	Example	Respond within
SEV-1	Customers cannot log in or payments fail for many users	15 minutes
SEV-2	A major feature is broken for some customers	30 minutes
SEV-3	A minor bug with a workaround	Next working day

After an incident

Every SEV-1 and SEV-2 incident gets a written, blameless post-mortem within 5 working days, shared on the engineering wiki. After a night with a SEV-1 incident, the on-call engineer may start late or take the next morning off.

Weekend support for Customer Support

Customer Support covers Saturdays and Sundays from 09:00 to 18:00 IST on a rotation. Each weekend day worked earns a compensatory off, to be used within 60 days, and a weekend allowance of Rs. 1,500 per day.

Part C: Finance

21. Payroll and Salary Structure

Pay day

Salaries are paid on the **last working day of each month** into your bank account. Payslips are on Pulse on the same day. If you join after the 20th, your first month's salary is paid with the next month's salary.

Salary structure

Component	Share of fixed pay	Notes
Basic salary	50%	Basis for PF, gratuity and leave encashment
House rent allowance (HRA)	20%	Tax-free in part if you pay rent
Special allowance	Balance	Fully taxable
Employer PF contribution	12% of basic	Part of cost to company
Work-from-home stipend	Fixed amount	See Hybrid work

Tax declarations

Declare your planned tax-saving investments on Pulse by **30 April**. Submit proofs by **15 January**. Without proofs, tax is deducted as if no investments were made for the last three months of the financial year.

Variable pay

Employees at level 4 and above have variable pay of 10% of fixed pay, paid once a year in May, based on company results and the annual rating.

Salary advance

In an emergency, you may ask Finance for a salary advance of up to one month's net pay, repaid over a maximum of 6 months, interest free.

22. Expense Reimbursement

We pay back reasonable costs you spend on company work. Spend company money as if it were your own.

How to claim

- Submit claims on Pulse under Expenses, with a clear photo or PDF of each receipt.
- Submit claims within **30 days** of spending. Claims older than 90 days are not paid.
- Claims submitted by the **5th of a month** are paid with that month's salary.
- Your manager approves claims up to Rs. 25,000; larger claims also need the department head.

Expense limits

Policy code	Category	Limit
FIN-EXP-01	Local travel (cab/auto) for work	Actuals, Rs. 3,000 per month
FIN-EXP-02	Late night cab (office exit after 21:00)	Actuals
FIN-EXP-03	Mobile and internet (non-WFH roles)	Rs. 1,000 per month
FIN-EXP-04	Team lunch (once a quarter)	Rs. 1,200 per person
FIN-EXP-05	Fitness membership	Rs. 1,500 per month
FIN-EXP-06	Books and courses	From the learning budget
FIN-EXP-07	Client entertainment	Rs. 3,000 per person, pre-approval needed
FIN-EXP-08	Home office setup (one time)	Rs. 15,000

Not reimbursed

- Alcohol, except client entertainment under FIN-EXP-07.
- Traffic fines and parking fines.
- Personal travel added to a business trip.
- Lost personal items, and upgrades to business class or premium economy.

Company credit cards

Managers and people who travel often may get a company credit card. Limits and rules are in the Corporate Cards and Petty Cash chapter.

23. Travel Policy

Booking

Book all work travel through the travel desk on Pulse at least 7 days before a domestic trip and 21 days before an international trip. Bookings made later need department head approval. Travel needs approval from your manager before booking.

Class of travel

- Flights: economy class for all employees, on all domestic and international flights under 8 hours.
- Flights over 8 hours: premium economy for level 5 and above.
- Trains: AC 2-tier, or AC chair car for day trips.
- Local travel at the destination: cabs at actuals (the monthly FIN-EXP-01 limit does not apply on trips).

Hotels and daily allowance

City tier	Examples	Hotel per night	Daily allowance
Tier 1	Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru	Rs. 7,000	Rs. 1,500
Tier 2	Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata	Rs. 5,500	Rs. 1,200
Tier 3	All other Indian cities	Rs. 4,000	Rs. 1,000
International	Any country	USD 180	USD 60

The daily allowance covers meals and small costs, and is paid without receipts. If meals are provided (for example at a conference), the allowance is halved for that day.

Travel insurance

International trips are covered by the company's travel insurance. Download the certificate from the travel desk before you fly.

24. Corporate Cards and Petty Cash

Who gets a corporate card

Corporate credit cards are issued to managers, the Sales team, and employees who travel for work more than 4 times a year. Request a card on Pulse; Finance issues it within 10 working days.

Card limits

Card holder	Monthly limit	Single transaction limit
Employees who travel often	Rs. 50,000	Rs. 25,000
Managers	Rs. 1,00,000	Rs. 50,000
Department heads	Rs. 3,00,000	Rs. 1,50,000

Using the card

- Use the card only for company expenses that follow the Expense and Travel policies.
- Upload the receipt for every transaction on Pulse within 7 days.
- Personal spending on the card, even if repaid, is a breach of policy.
- Report a lost card to the bank and to finance@nimbuslabs.example immediately.

Petty cash

Each office keeps a petty cash float of Rs. 20,000, held by the office manager, for small urgent purchases such as courier charges or repairs. Single petty cash payments are limited to Rs. 2,000. The float is reconciled with receipts every Friday.

25. Budgets and Cost Centres

Financial year

Our financial year runs from **1 April to 31 March**, the same as the Indian tax year. Budgets are planned in February and approved by the board in March.

Cost centres

Every employee and every expense belongs to a cost centre. Department heads own their cost centre's budget and review spending every month with Finance.

Cost centre	Code	Owner
Engineering	CC-100	VP Engineering
Product and Design	CC-200	Head of Product
Sales and Marketing	CC-300	Chief Revenue Officer
Customer Support	CC-400	Head of Support
People and Admin	CC-500	Chief People Officer
Finance and Legal	CC-600	CFO

Overspending

If a cost centre expects to spend more than 5% above its quarterly budget, the owner must tell the CFO in writing before the spend. Unplanned spending above 10% needs CEO approval.

Month-end close

Finance closes the books by the **7th working day** of every month. Approve any pending invoices and expense claims in your queue before the 3rd working day, so they land in the right month.

26. Procurement and Approvals

This chapter covers buying software, services and equipment for the company.

Approval matrix

Purchase value (per year)	Approval needed	Quotes needed
Up to Rs. 50,000	Manager	1
Rs. 50,001 to Rs. 5,00,000	Department head + Finance	2
Rs. 5,00,001 to Rs. 25,00,000	CFO	3
Above Rs. 25,00,000	CEO and CFO	3 + legal review

Software and SaaS

Any new tool that stores company or customer data needs a security review by IT before purchase, whatever its price. Free trials are fine, but never upload customer data to a tool under trial.

Vendor onboarding

New vendors are added by Finance after receiving their GST certificate, PAN, cancelled cheque and signed contract. Vendors are paid on net 30 terms, in the payment run every Friday.

Purchase orders

Purchases above Rs. 50,000 need a purchase order (PO) raised on Pulse before the vendor starts work. Invoices without a PO number are sent back.

27. Customer Billing and Collections

This chapter is for the Sales, Customer Success and Finance teams, but everyone should know how we charge customers.

Plans and billing

Plan	Price	Billing
Starter	Rs. 799 per month	Monthly, by card or UPI autopay
Growth	Rs. 1,999 per month	Monthly or yearly (2 months free)
Enterprise	Custom	Yearly invoice, net 30

Discounts

Sales can offer up to 15% off a yearly Growth plan without approval. Discounts from 15% to 30% need the Chief Revenue Officer. Anything above 30%, or any free months beyond the standard offer, needs the CFO.

Collections

Enterprise invoices are due 30 days after the invoice date. Finance sends reminders on day 31 and day 45. At 60 days overdue, the account is moved to read-only mode after the account manager has called the customer.

Refunds

Monthly plans are not refunded for a partly used month. Yearly plans cancelled within 30 days of purchase are refunded in full; after that, unused months are refunded only with CFO approval.

GST

All prices are shown before GST. GST at 18% is added to every invoice. Customers can add their GSTIN on the billing page to claim input tax credit.

28. Company Assets and Equipment

Laptops

Engineers and designers get a MacBook Pro; other roles get a MacBook Air. Laptops are refreshed every **3 years**. You are responsible for the laptop's safe keeping. A laptop lost through negligence (for example, left in a parked car) may be charged to you at its depreciated value.

Accessories

You may order a monitor, keyboard, mouse and headset from the IT catalogue on day one. Home office furniture is covered by FIN-EXP-08.

Returning equipment

All equipment is returned on or before your last working day. Unreturned equipment is deducted from the full and final settlement at its depreciated value.

Buying your laptop

When your laptop is refreshed, or when you leave after at least 2 years, you may buy your old laptop at its depreciated book value, after IT wipes it.

Addendum

29. Addendum: Changes from 1 July 2026

The following changes were approved by the leadership team on 15 June 2026 and apply from **1 July 2026**. Where these differ from earlier chapters, this Addendum replaces them.

- **Work-from-home stipend** is revised from Rs. 2,000 to **Rs. 2,500 per month**.
- **Paternity leave** is extended from 10 to **15 working days**, to be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption.
- **Learning budget** rises from Rs. 40,000 to **Rs. 50,000 per financial year**, from the 2026-27 financial year.
- **Expense claims** must now be submitted within 21 days (previously 30 days).

Unchanged

Earned leave, sick leave, the notice period, the health insurance cover, and the travel limits are unchanged.

30. Frequently Asked Questions

Can I work fully from home?

Only if you live more than 60 km from both offices and your department head and HR approve. Otherwise you work from the office on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday.

Who do I contact for payslip errors?

Raise a ticket on Pulse under Payroll, or email payroll@nimbuslabs.example. Errors raised before the 20th are fixed in the same month.

Can I take earned leave during my notice period?

Only with your manager's approval, and it does not shorten the notice period.

What happens to my insurance when I leave?

Cover ends on your last working day. You can convert it to an individual policy with the insurer within 30 days, at your own cost.

How do I change my bank account?

Update it on Pulse before the 15th of the month, with a cancelled cheque. Changes after the 15th apply from the next month.

Where can I find this handbook?

The latest version is always on the People wiki. Printed copies are out of date the day they are printed.

31. Contacts and Glossary

Team	Email	Slack
People (HR)	people@nimbuslabs.example	#ask-people
Payroll	payroll@nimbuslabs.example	#ask-payroll
Finance	finance@nimbuslabs.example	#ask-finance
IT	it@nimbuslabs.example	#ask-it
Security incidents	it-security@nimbuslabs.example	#security-incident
Internal Committee (POSH)	ic@nimbuslabs.example	-

Glossary

- **Pulse:** our HR portal, used for leave, expenses, reviews, payroll and referrals.
- **EL / SL / CL:** earned leave, sick leave, casual leave.
- **CTC:** cost to company, the total yearly cost of your employment, including employer PF.
- **F&F:** full and final settlement, paid after you leave.
- **IC:** Internal Committee under the POSH Act.
- **PIP:** performance improvement plan.